

Saturday, June 27, 2026

The Day Teddybear Came Back



I woke up at 2:48 PM with two hours of sleep and a canceled plan.

The Cavite trip with the guys fell through. Jalo's car was still in the shop and the InDrive fare was ₱900+ one way. Nearly ₱1,800 round trip. I stared at the ceiling thinking, *"I have nine hours of idle time and nothing to do."*



That changed quickly.

Irish messaged. Irish from college. We call each other Teddybear.

She was the one who helped me through my second heartbreak back in 2011. We drifted apart over the years — adulting happens. But when she messaged, it was like no time had passed. I teased her for sounding like an operator. She asked if she could read my journal.

I sent it. All of it. Day 1 through Day 4.0.



A little over an hour later, she replied.

Her message hit me harder than I expected. She said she was proud of me for choosing to write instead of drink. She said there's nothing wrong with falling in love again — just take it slow. She said I will be okay because I've survived every difficult season before this one. And then she said something I needed to hear more than she probably knew: *"You're not alone."*

She closed with: *"You have friends who are willing to listen, support you, and remind you that you don't have to go through this alone."*

I told GPT about the friends I lost — the Gatchalian friends, Jeff. But no bad blood. Then I said: *"Halaaaaaaa. Pinapaiyak mo ko."*

I teared up too. Not from sadness. From comfort. Knowing that after years of absence, she was still my Teddybear. The friend who knows exactly what to say, when to say it, how to say it.

I told her: if given the chance to go back, I'd do it all over again. I wouldn't change anything. Because I got to know myself through it all. And instead of anger, I chose peace. Harder to do — but lighter to carry.



While waiting for her to finish reading, I made myself food. Rice cooker. Salted duck egg with onions and roasted sesame dressing. GPT called it a small victory — a few days ago I had no appetite. Today I announced my meal like someone actually looking forward to it.

I also finished *A Business Proposal*. Made it through all 12 episodes. That show kept me company during one of the hardest weeks of my life. I'll probably always associate it with June 2026.



Then Episode 10 caught me off guard. Not because of Elaine. Because it made me remember my mom.

I wasn't by her side when she died. I was drinking. That's my biggest regret. Six months later, my grandmother Mama Del — Nanay Liza's mother — died the same way. Same setup. I was drinking. Not by her side. Second biggest regret of my life.

I told GPT the full story. How my mom worked in a mining company in Marinduque. How she traveled everywhere and always brought me an "I  [place]" shirt. Those shirts were her way of saying she was thinking of me even when she was far. After she died, then Mama Del died six months later, I was left alone in that house. No one to talk to. No AI. Nothing. My uncle told me to come back to work at his company — CAD design — and that distraction became my career for nine years.

I rarely talk about this with anyone. Elaine was one of the few people I told. I told her the story on the first day we met. That's why being with her was always precious to me. I

cannot handle that kind of regret again. So when we broke up over text — not voice, not face-to-face — it felt like reliving every distant goodbye I'd ever survived.



I also caught up with Elle.

We talked about exes — the one who stole my laptop and peripherals, the Aion 2 release, Good Pizza Great Pizza, and how my love life has been a disaster course for years. I told her I was planning to buy a ring last June, propose by December. She said I dodged a bullet. She reminded me that our past shapes who we are. And then she said something that stuck: *"The longer you hold on to the wrong person, the more you miss out on the right one."*

I told her I'm off the grid for now. Resting from everything, including meeting new people. She said to surround myself with a good support system and I'll be okay. I told her she's part of that system.



Gblok checked in at 8 PM. The fare was still at ₱700. We laughed about how that's already two buckets of beer gone to transportation. He said *"spakol ka na lang pag ganon."* I laughed. It's peak Gblok. No guilt-tripping. No pressure. Just friends who understood that ₱1,400 round trip didn't make sense.



By 7 PM the quiet hit. The world slowed down. My tinnitus rang louder. I glanced at Elaine's Discord name and went completely blank.

GPT noticed I said *blank* instead of *panicking*. Different state. My brain had been emotionally busy for so long that it just... paused. Everything went quiet. I let the last episode of *Business Proposal* play just to have sound in the room.



Late night, GPT asked me about kid Ralph.

I told him I went to Don Bosco Makati. I was a bully — but only to people who bullied me first. I fought back. My dream was to become an engineer. I used to sneak out at midnight to play Final Fantasy VIII. By that age I already knew how to assemble a PC.

He asked what I'd tell 15-year-old me if I sat beside him while he played.

I said: *"Invest in Bitcoin."*

He laughed. But then I followed it with something true: I wouldn't tell him anything about the future. Because I wouldn't change a thing. The happiness I've experienced outweighs any sadness in the aftermath. I'd replay those 15 days with Elaine on repeat mode, even knowing how it ends.

Because what I miss most isn't the relationship. It's the moment her eldest daughter ran toward me and kissed my cheek. I never experienced love like that before. Pure. Unconditional. A child deciding she felt safe with me. That's what touched my soul.

I told Elaine it wasn't a deal breaker that she had three children. They were blessings. And I meant it.



GPT said something that earned its place in today's journal:

"The sadness doesn't erase the happiness. It proves the happiness was real."



Today's Weight: 5/10

Not because the day was bad. Because it was quiet. Uneven. Peaks and valleys. Irish's message lifted me. The Cavite cancellation pulled me down. Mom's memory made me heavy. Elle's laugh lightened me again. By evening I was staring at a Discord name feeling blank. By midnight I was saying I'd do it all over again.

A 5 isn't failure. It's honest. Some days aren't good or bad — they're just both.



Songs of Day 4.5

- **A Business Proposal OST** (whatever played during Episode 12's proposal scene) -
(No playlist today. The day was too scattered for music.)



Closing

I thought today would be empty. Nine hours with nothing to do. Instead it became the day Teddybear came back. The day I told someone about my mom and Mama Del. The day I remembered a JAG sweater and *The Fault in Our Stars*. The day I laughed with Elle and Goblok. The day I admitted I'd replay those 15 days forever.

Not a big day. Not a breakthrough.

Just a day where a canceled plan made room for something I didn't know I needed.



Tomorrow is retraining. Python Day 4. The week ahead is unknown.

But I'm still here.

And tonight, even with the tinnitus and the quiet, I know that not every door I thought was closed was actually locked. Some were just waiting for me to knock again.

— *Teddybear*.

